

SSLC ENGLISH GRAMMAR COMPLETE GUIDE (2026)

This Document was prepared by keeping SSLC students in mind, I suggest all of you to go through this file once to understand the concepts in brief. Refer other pyq's for more stability, and check if after reading this document you were able to answer other questions from the pyq's correctly.

1. ARTICLES

Articles are small words used before nouns (naming words). They help us know whether we are talking about something in general or something specific.

Articles used in English are: a, an, the.

When does this come in SSLC exam?

Articles are asked in fill-in-the-blanks questions.

How to do it – Step by Step

Step 1: Look at the word after the blank.

Step 2: Check the sound of the word (not spelling).

Step 3: Decide whether the noun is general or specific.

Rules to follow

- Use 'a' before consonant sounds (a boy, a university).

- Use 'an' before vowel sounds (an apple, an hour).
- Use 'the' for specific or unique things (the sun, the principal).

Examples

- He is a teacher.
- She ate an apple.
- The sun rises in the east.

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q4)

Arya has ___ bachelor's degree from ___ University of Madras.

Answer: a, the

2. QUESTION TAGS

A question tag is a short question added at the end of a sentence to confirm information.

When does this come in SSLC exam?

Asked as MCQ or fill-in-the-blank.

How to do it – Step by Step

Step 1: Check if the sentence is positive or negative.

Step 2: Find the helping verb (auxiliary verb – helping verb).

Step 3: Use the opposite form in the tag.

Step 4: Match the subject.

Structure

Positive sentence → Negative tag

Negative sentence → Positive tag

Examples

- He is late, isn't he?
- She doesn't like tea, does she?
- They are students, aren't they?

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-2 Q5)

He will leave for Patna tonight, _____?

Answer: won't he?

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-3, Q2)

Farmer grows food for the country, _____?

Answer: doesn't he?

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q1)

The ambitious girl will become the chief minister of the state, _____?

Answer: won't she?

3. CLAUSES

A clause is a group of words that has a subject and a verb. In SSLC, clauses are tested through sentence transformation.

When does this come in SSLC exam?

Asked while changing simple sentences into complex sentences.

How to do it – Step by Step

Step 1: Find words like 'too...to'.

Step 2: Change them into 'so...that'.

Step 3: Use correct helping verb.

Example

Simple: She is too poor to buy a car.

Complex: She is so poor that she cannot buy a car.

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-2 Q13)

She is too poor to own a car.

Answer: She is so poor that she cannot own a car.

4. CHANGE OF VOICE

Voice tells us whether the subject does the action or receives the action.

When does this come in SSLC exam?

Asked as sentence rewriting (active ↔ passive).

How to do it – Step by Step

Step 1: Identify subject, verb and object.

Step 2: Make object the subject.

Step 3: Change verb form but keep the tense same.

Example

Active: She wrote a letter.

Passive: A letter was written by her.

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q11)

Madhavi was cooking a nice meal.

Answer: A nice meal was being cooked by Madhavi.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-2, Q12)

He gave her a ring.

Answer: She was given a ring by him.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q11)

Who killed the snake?

Answer: By whom was the snake killed?

5. REPORTED SPEECH

Reported speech is used to tell what someone said without using their exact words.

When does this come in SSLC exam?

Asked as sentence conversion (direct → indirect).

How to do it – Step by Step

Step 1: Change reporting verb (said → asked).

Step 2: Change tense.

Step 3: Change pronouns and time words.

Example

Direct: He said, 'I am tired.'

Indirect: He said that he was tired.

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q30)

The king said to his minister, 'Are these my brave heroes?'

Answer: The king asked his minister whether those were his brave heroes.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-2, Q30)

Seetha said, "I waited for Ramu till 10 o'clock."

Answer: Seetha said that she had waited for Ramu till 10 o'clock.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q28)

He said to us, "Will you listen to such a fool?"

Answer: He asked us whether we would listen to such a fool.

6. DEGREES OF COMPARISON

Degrees of comparison are used to compare qualities of people or things.

Types

Positive – no comparison

Comparative – compares two

Superlative – compares more than two

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q28)

Mysore is one of the most vibrant cities in India.

Answer: Mysore is more vibrant than many other cities in India.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-2, Q28)

Very few students are as helpful as Meera.

Answer:

- Comparative: Meera is more helpful than most other students.
- Superlative: Meera is one of the most helpful students.

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q29)

Suresh is lazier than any other boy in the class.

Answer:

- Positive: No other boy in the class is as lazy as Suresh.
- Superlative: Suresh is the laziest boy in the class.

7. AS SOON AS / NO SOONER THAN

These are used to show that one action happens immediately after another.

How to do it

- As soon as → simple past
- No sooner → past perfect + than

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q29)

I opened the newspaper. I read a shocking news.

Answer: As soon as I opened the newspaper, I read a shocking news.

8. EXCLAMATORY SENTENCES

Exclamatory sentences express strong feelings like joy, surprise or pain.

How to do it

Step 1: Start with How or What.

Step 2: End with exclamation mark (!).

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q13)

She dances very beautifully.

Answer: How beautifully she dances!

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q12)

How wonderfully Priya manages her house!

Answer: Priya manages her house very wonderfully.

9. FIGURE OF SPEECH

Figure of speech is a special way of using words to make language more interesting.

Common types asked in SSLC

- Simile – comparison using like or as
- Personification – giving human qualities

Verified PYQ

(SSLC 2025 Exam-3 Q3)

The car engine roared like a fierce lion.

Answer: Simile

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-2, Q6)

The sun sheds his beams on rich and poor alike.

Answer: Personification

(SSLC 2025 – Exam-1, Q6)

Death lays its icy hands on the king.

Answer: Personification